A Court Said Yes, but a Family Is Still Waiting

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For almost a year, one family has lived in two different countries while waiting for one important paper: a **visa**. Dustin Hoffman is a U.S. Army **veteran**. He started the paperwork late last year so his wife, Gloria, could live in the United States. Gloria is from Colombia. She stayed in Argentina with their 5-year-old daughter, Chaya, and Hoffman's 12-year-old stepson, Israel. Hoffman says he misses them every day. In January, the Trump **administration** stopped processing **immigrant visas** for people from 75 countries. Gloria is from Colombia, one of those countries. In August, a **federal** judge ordered the ban to be lifted. But the Hoffman family still has not got its **visa**. The State Department has asked for more proof that the family can support itself without public help. Lawyers for **migrants** say this shows a bigger problem. They say interviews and **visa** stamps are still moving slowly, so the court order has not ended the wait.

Word Treasure

visa -- A visa is an official paper that lets a person enter and live in another country.
veteran -- A veteran is someone who served in the military in the past.
immigrant -- An immigrant is a person who moves to a new country to live there.
federal -- Federal means connected to the national government of a country.
administration -- An administration is the group of people who run a government.
migrants -- Migrants are people who move from one place or country to another.

Background you need

A visa is a paper that lets a person move to and live in another country.

To get one, a family fills out forms and shows it can pay its own way, and then officials check the forms and hold interviews.

A court can order a rule to stop, but the family still has to wait until the checks are done.

Break it down

WHO: Dustin Hoffman, his wife Gloria, their daughter Chaya, and his stepson Israel
WHAT: The family is still waiting for a visa even after a judge ordered the ban lifted
WHERE: Gloria, Chaya, and Israel are in Argentina while Hoffman is in the United States
WHY: Visa processing was stopped and then moved slowly, and more proof of support was asked for

Why it matters

Families should be able to live together, and rules about moving to a new country can change a child's everyday life.

Test what you remember

1. What important paper is the family still waiting for?

- (A) A plane ticket
- (B) A school report
- (C) A visa
- (D) A birthday card

2. Where has Gloria stayed with the children?

- (A) In Colombia
- (B) In Canada
- (C) In the United States
- (D) In Argentina

3. Who started the paperwork so Gloria could live in the United States?

- (A) Gloria
- (B) Dustin Hoffman
- (C) Israel
- (D) Chaya

4. What did a federal judge order?

- (A) The interviews to stop
- (B) The family to move at once
- (C) The ban to be lifted
- (D) The visa to be printed

5. Why is the family still waiting?

- (A) More proof was asked for that the family can support itself
- (B) They changed their minds
- (C) The court said no
- (D) They lost the paper

6. For about how long has the family lived in two different countries?

- (A) For one day
- (B) For almost a year
- (C) For five years
- (D) For one week

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: D 3: B 4: C 5: A 6: B

Questions to think about

1. The State Department: It has asked for more proof that the family can support itself without public help.

2. Lawyers for migrants: They say slow interviews and visa stamps show a bigger problem, so the court order has not ended the wait.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):